

Preservation bingo

Category	Bingo - Vocabulary game - Group activity
Skill level	Beginner to run. You are the caller - read a term and the clue that fits the player's age from the call sheet (or the digital caller reads it for you). No food-preservation expertise required.
Audience	All ages - every term has a clue for Kids, Tweens, Teens, and Adults. Use the icon cards for younger kids, the text cards for teens and adults.
Setup time	10-15 minutes

DESCRIPTION

A classic 5x5 bingo using food-preservation terms (equipment, processes, safety concepts, ingredients, and results). The caller draws a term and reads a clue at the right age level; players mark the term if it is on their card. First to five in a row calls "Bingo!" 72 terms across 8 topics, with 30 unique cards (15 text cards for teens/adults, 15 icon cards for kids/tweens).

MATERIALS NEEDED

Digital version (tablet)

- A tablet open to the Bingo caller: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Toolkit," then "Open caller" on the Preservation bingo card. Pick the age level (Kids / Tweens / Teens / Adult) so it shows the right clue.

Printed version (no technology needed)

- Printed bingo cards: "bingo-cards-adults.pdf" (text) and/or "bingo-cards-kids.pdf" (with topic icons) - 2 cards per sheet.
- The "Volunteer call sheet" (volunteer-call-sheet.pdf) - every term with a Kids/Tweens/Teens/Adult clue and a checkbox to track what you have called.
- Something to draw terms with: cut the call-sheet terms into a bowl, or just call down the sheet in a shuffled order.

Both versions

- Bingo markers: dried beans, pennies, bingo daubers, or just pens.
- Table and MFP / OSU Extension signage; optional take-home educational handouts.
- This Activity guide on the table.

SETUP

1. Print the bingo cards you need (2 per sheet) and cut each sheet in half. Give each player one card and a handful of markers.
2. Digital: open the caller and choose the age level. Printed: print the Volunteer call sheet and keep it in front of you.
3. Tell players the goal (five in a row - across, down, or diagonal; the center is a FREE space).

ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

Running it (digital caller or printed call sheet)

1. Pick the age level so the clue matches your players (Kids / Tweens / Teens / Adult).
2. Draw a term: tap "Draw next term" on the caller, or pick/read the next term from the call sheet and check it off.

3. Read the term out loud, then read its clue. Players look for that term on their card and cover it.
4. Keep drawing. When a player covers five in a row, they call "Bingo!"
5. Check their card against the called terms (the caller shows everything called; the call sheet has your checkmarks), congratulate them, and start a new round.

VOLUNTEER NOTES

- You are the caller and do not need to be an expert - every term has a ready clue for each age group. Just read the one that fits your players.
- Match the clue to the table: use the Kids clue (and the icon cards) for little ones, the Adult clue for grown-ups.
- Accuracy matters: read the clues as written; do not improvise food-safety advice. Refer deeper questions to a Master Food Preserver.
- Keep rounds short when there is a crowd. A "blackout" (whole card) round is a fun longer challenge.
- There are no prizes - calling "Bingo!" and the conversation along the way are the fun.
- No tablet, or prefer paper? The printed cards and call sheet play exactly the same.
- Simple tablet help: tap "Draw next term" for each call; the panel lists every term already called so you can verify a win. It works without internet once open.
- Restock markers, and sanitize hands and surfaces as needed.